

May 26, 2026 09:18 AM GMT

## General Machinery | Japan

# Machine Tools: Apr 2026 Confirmed Orders: China Recovers to Record Levels, Sharp Domestic Expansion Led by Autos & Electrical

## Key Takeaways

- External demand for machine tools in Apr by region saw China at ¥53.3bn (+57% YoY), US ¥35.8bn (+32%), and Europe ¥20.3bn (+47% YoY; EU alone +56%).
- China continued to show strong growth, driven by general machinery and electrical/precision machinery. Order value recovered to near record-high levels.
- The US showed ongoing YoY growth above 30%. General machinery edged down slightly, but aerospace and shipbuilding grew firmly, while autos and electrical/precision also expanded steadily.
- Europe (EU region) saw YoY increases across all industries, incl. general machinery, autos, electrical/precision, and aerospace/shipbuilding, but this largely reflects a very low YoY base.
- Domestic demand recovered +43% YoY. Autos (+114% YoY) and electrical/precision (+62%) were the main drivers. Focus on the sustainability of auto-related demand ahead.

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## GENERAL MACHINERY

Japan

Industry View

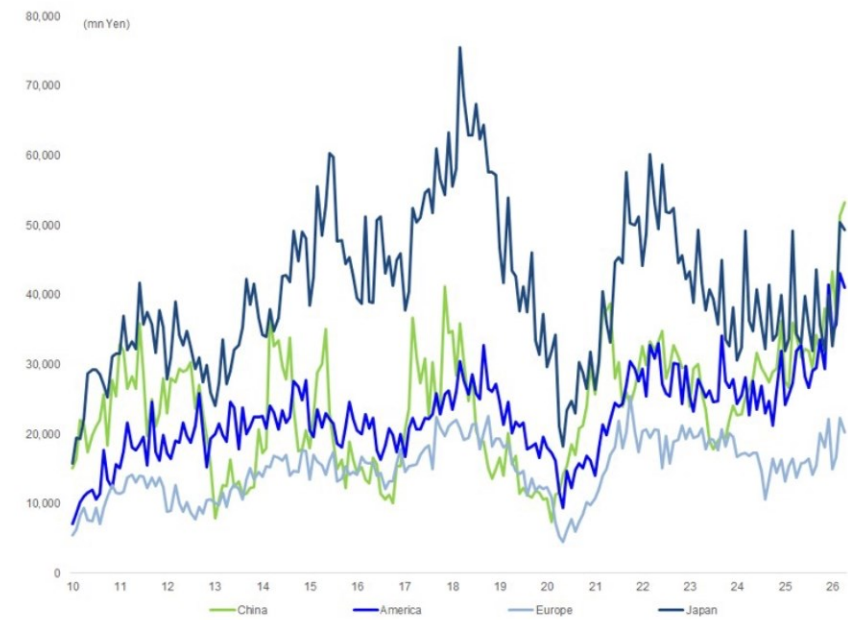
In-Line

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Exhibit 1: Machine tool orders: Exports by region



Source: JMTBA, Morgan Stanley Research

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|-----------------------|-------------------|------------|----------------------------------|----------------|----------------------|---------------------------------------------------|-----------------------|
|                       | Count             | % of Total | Count                            | % of Total IBC | % of Rating Category | Count                                             | % of Total Other MISC |
| Overweight/Buy        | 1546              | 42%        | 467                              | 51%            | 30%                  | 709                                               | 44%                   |
| Equal-weight/Hold     | 1568              | 43%        | 358                              | 39%            | 23%                  | 715                                               | 44%                   |
| Not-Rated/Hold        | 4                 | 0%         | 0                                | 0%             | 0%                   | 1                                                 | 0%                    |
| Underweight/Sell      | 555               | 15%        | 84                               | 9%             | 15%                  | 202                                               | 12%                   |
| Total                 | 3,673             |            | 909                              |                |                      | 1627                                              |                       |

Data include common stock and ADRs currently assigned ratings. Investment Banking Clients are companies from whom Morgan Stanley received investment banking compensation in the last 12 months. Due to rounding off of decimals, the percentages provided in the "% of total" column may not add up to exactly 100 percent.

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|----------------------------|----------------|---------------------|
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| Daikin Industries (6367.T) | U (11/27/2020) | ¥23,135             |
| DMG Mori (6141.T)          | E (05/02/2026) | ¥3,383              |
| Komatsu (6301.T)           | O (12/01/2017) | ¥6,530              |
| Kubota (6326.T)            | E (09/09/2024) | ¥2,700              |
| Makita (6586.T)            | E (04/04/2022) | ¥5,702              |
| Okuma (6103.T)             | O (01/16/2025) | ¥4,065              |
| Shimano (7309.T)           | E (05/29/2014) | ¥16,565             |

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